RANGPUR

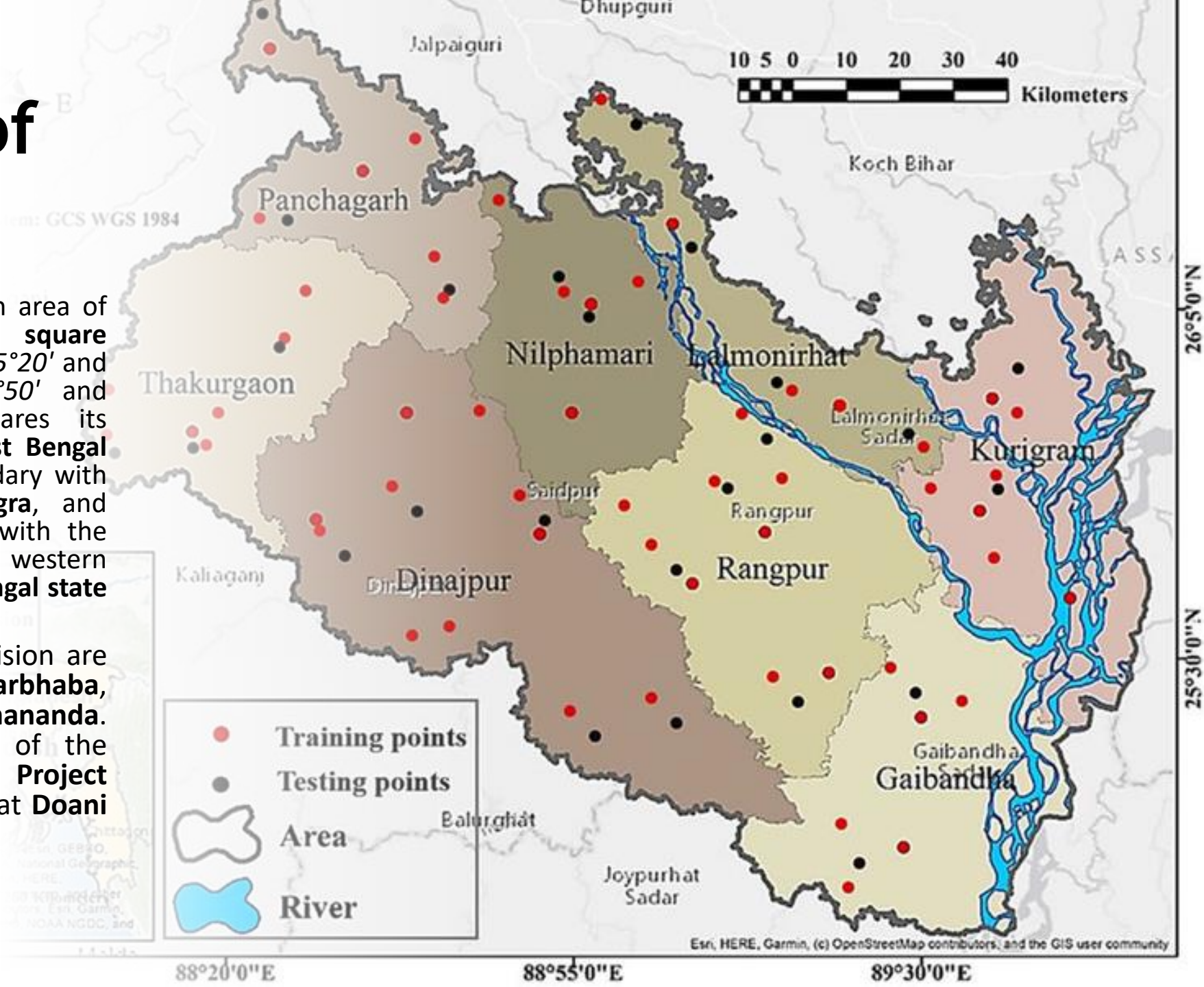


Division

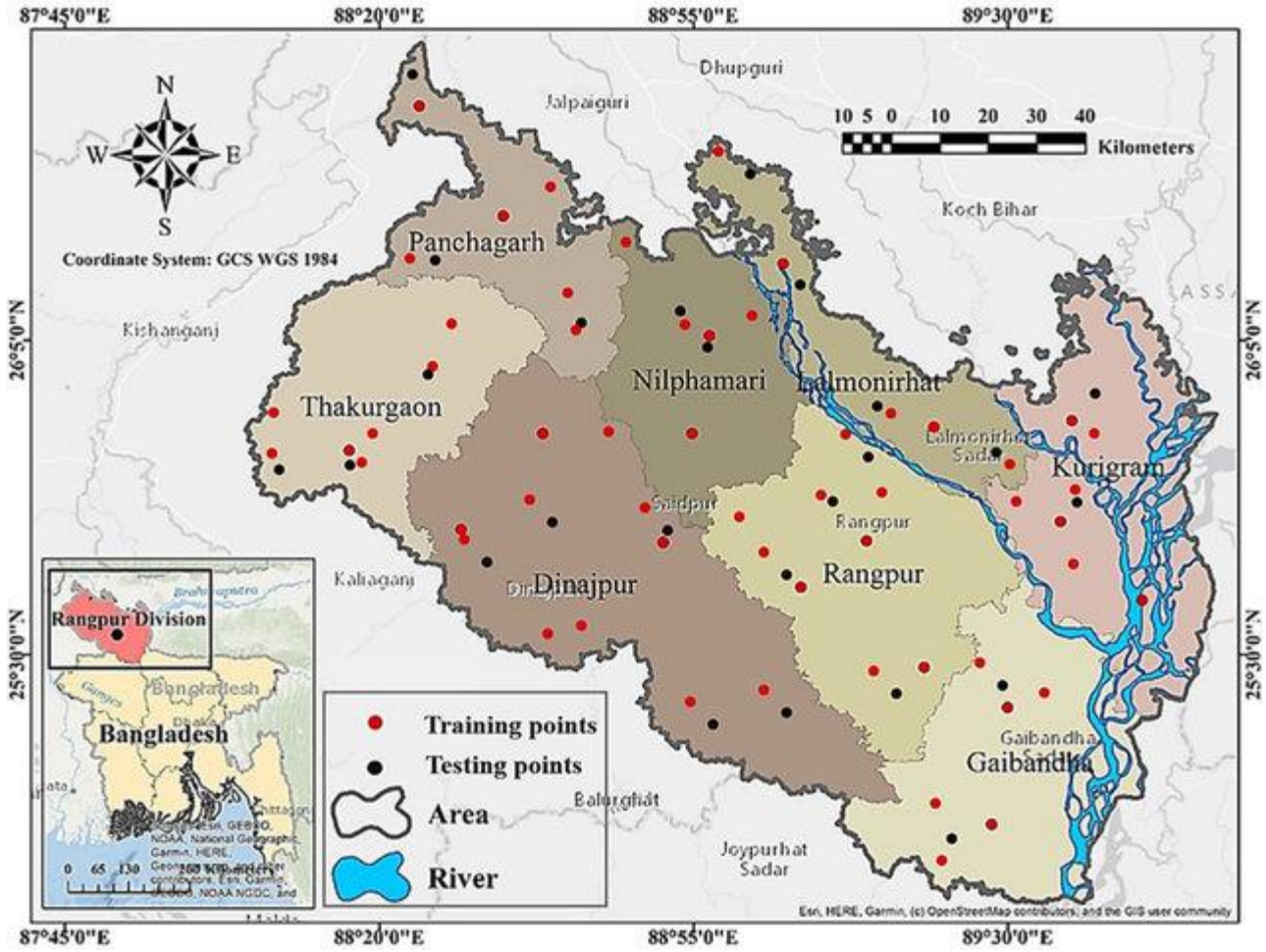
Location of Rangpur

Rangpur Division encompasses an area of approximately **16,185.01 square kilometers**, positioned between *25°20′* and *26°37′* north latitudes and *88°50′* and *89°53′* east longitudes. It shares its northern boundary with the **West Bengal state of India**, its southern boundary with the districts of **Joypurhat**, **Bogra**, and **Jamalpur**, its eastern boundary with the **Assam state of India**, and its western boundary again with the **West Bengal state of India**.

The main rivers of Rangpur Division are the **Brahmaputra**, **Jamuna**, **Punarbhaba**, **Karatoya**, **Atrai**, **Tista**, and **Mahananda**. The largest irrigation project of the country, the **Tista Barrage Project** *(length: 615 meters)*, is located at **Doani** in **Hatibandha Upazila**.



Map of Rangpur Division



Administrative Structure of Rangpur

Rangpur Division was formed on **25 January 2010**. It was created by comprising **eight districts** and **fifty-eight upazilas** previously part of the **Rajshahi Division**.

Division									
Area (sq km)	District	Upazila	Paurasabha	Union	Ward	Population		Density (per sq km)	Literacy rate (%)
						Urban	Rural		
16185.01	8	58	28	537	270	2109071	13678687	975	47.2

Source: Bangladesh Population Census 2011, Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics.

Administrative Structure of Rangpur

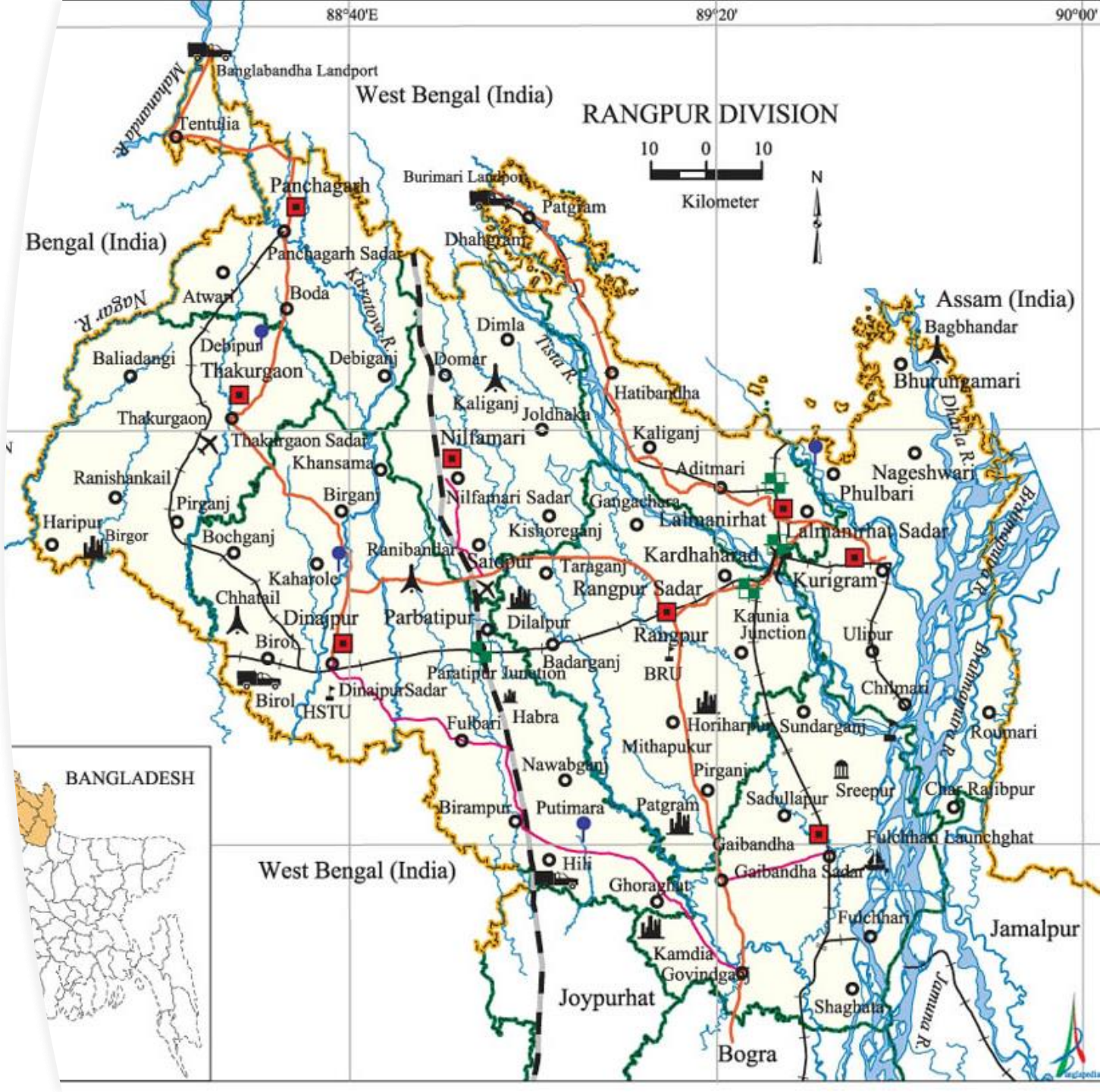
District											
Name of District	Area (sq km)	Upazila	Municipality	Ward	Mohalla	Union	Mouza	Village	Population	Density (per sq km)	Literacy rate (%)
Kurigram	2245.04	9	3	27	203	72	600	1872	2069273	922	42.5
Gaibandha	2114.77	7	3	27	74	82	1082	1250	2379255	1125	42.8
Thakurgaon	1781.74	5	3	30	59	51	638	641	1390042	780	48.7
Dinajpur	3444.30	13	8	75	276	101	1974	2131	2990128	868	52.4
Nilphamari	1546.59	6	4	42	82	60	355	361	1834231	1186	44.4
Panchagarh	1404.62	5	2	18	64	43	420	825	987644	703	51.8
Rangpur	2400.56	8	3	33	197	83	1197	1492	2881086	1200	48.5
Lalmonirhat	1247.37	5	2	18	87	45	345	478	1256099	1007	46.1

Rangpur City Corporation (RpCC)

Rangpur City Corporation (RpCC) is the local governing body responsible for administering the city of **Rangpur** and some adjoining areas. It operates under the supervision of the **Ministry of Local Government, Rural Development and Co-operatives (LGRD)**. The corporation functions in accordance with the provisions of the **City Corporation Act, 2009**.
Rangpur City Corporation is the **second-largest city corporation** in Bangladesh, covering a total area of **205.76 square kilometers**, with a population of approximately **796,556** people.

Demographics of Rangpur Division

According to the **2022 census**, **Rangpur Division** has a total population of **17,610,956**, with a population density of **1,088 persons per square kilometer**. The majority of the population are **Muslim**, comprising **86.51%**, followed by **Hindus** at approximately **12.98%**. A small percentage of the population adheres to **Christianity** and other religions. The largest ethnic group is the **Bengalis**, alongside several smaller indigenous ethnic communities, including the **Santal**, **Munda**, **Oraon**, and **Rajbanshi** (including **Kaibarta** and **Koch** communities).
In comparison, the **2011 census** recorded a total population of **15,787,758**, with a population density of **980 persons per square kilometer**. At that time, **males** constituted **51.18%** of the population, while **females** made up **48.82%**.

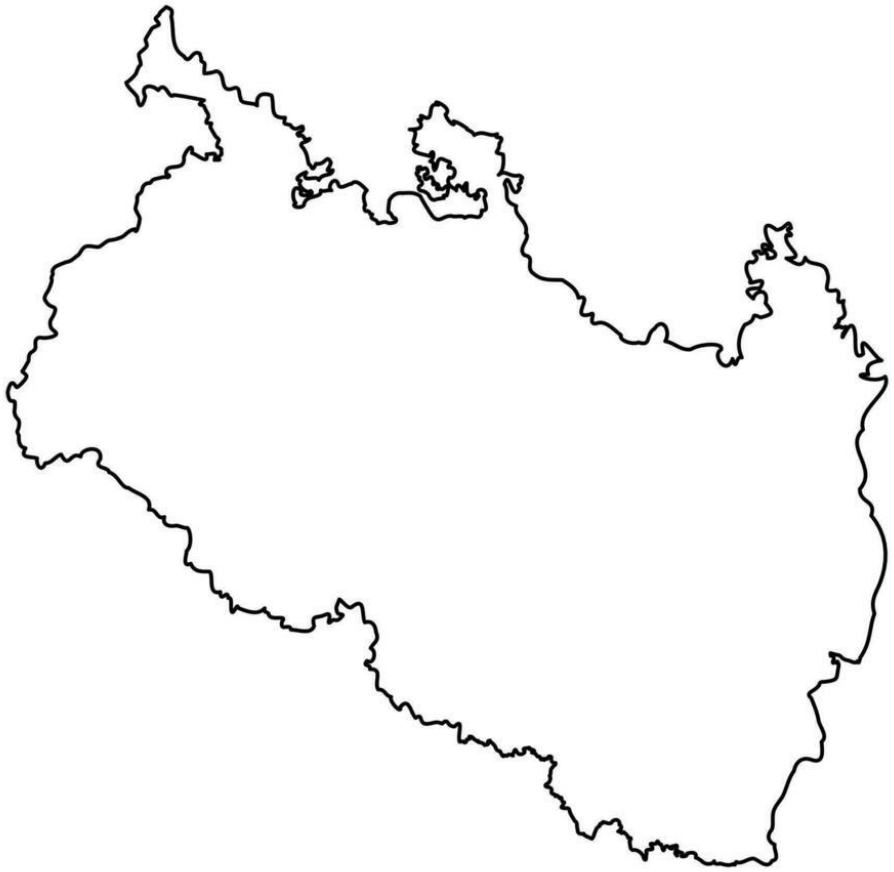


General Information

Category	Details
Area	16,320.26 sq. km
Population	15,537,676
Literacy Rate	56.0875%
Number of Upazilas	58
Number of Police Stations	60
Number of Municipalities	28
Number of Unions	536
Number of Mouzas	12,549
Number of Villages	9,106
Number of Rivers	76

Education Sector

Category	Details
Government Universities	1
Private Universities	1
Number of Colleges	396
Number of Secondary Schools	2,345
Government Primary Schools	4,365
Registered Non-Govt. Primary Schools	3,946
Number of Madrasas	1,538
Ebtedayee Madrasas	1,548
Polytechnic Institutes	16
Technical Schools and Colleges	69



Origin of the Name

Origin of the Name: The exact origin of the name **"Rangpur"** remains uncertain. Some believe that during the **Mahabharata era**, **King Bhagadatta** of **Pragjyotishpur** had a *palace of colors* (*Rang Mahal*) in this region, which led to the name "Rangpur." Others suggest that the name of **Payraband**, the birthplace of **Begum Rokeya**—the pioneer of women's awakening—originated from **Payrabati**, the daughter of King Bhagadatta. Some historians propose that Rangpur was once home to a dyeing factory where jute fabrics (gunny bags) were colored, originally called **Rangrezpur**, which eventually evolved into **Rangpur**. However, many historians attribute the origin of the name to **Ikhtiyar Uddin Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khilji**, noting that "Rangpur" is a **Persian word**, likely established during his rule.



History of Rangpur Division

Mughal Period

According to the *Ain-i-Akbari*, during the Mughal period, **Rangpur** consisted of three types of administrative areas. Rangpur was conquered by the army of **Raja Man Singh**, a commander under Mughal Emperor **Akbar**, in **1575**; however, it was not fully integrated into the Mughal Empire until **1686**. The Mughal administration was firmly established across Rangpur in **1611 AD**. Place names such as **Mughalbasa** ("a locality of the Mughals") and **Mughalhat** ("local market organized by the Mughals") bear testimony to the Mughal association and historical presence in Rangpur and its surrounding regions. Later, Rangpur passed under the control of the **Sarker of Ghoraghat**.

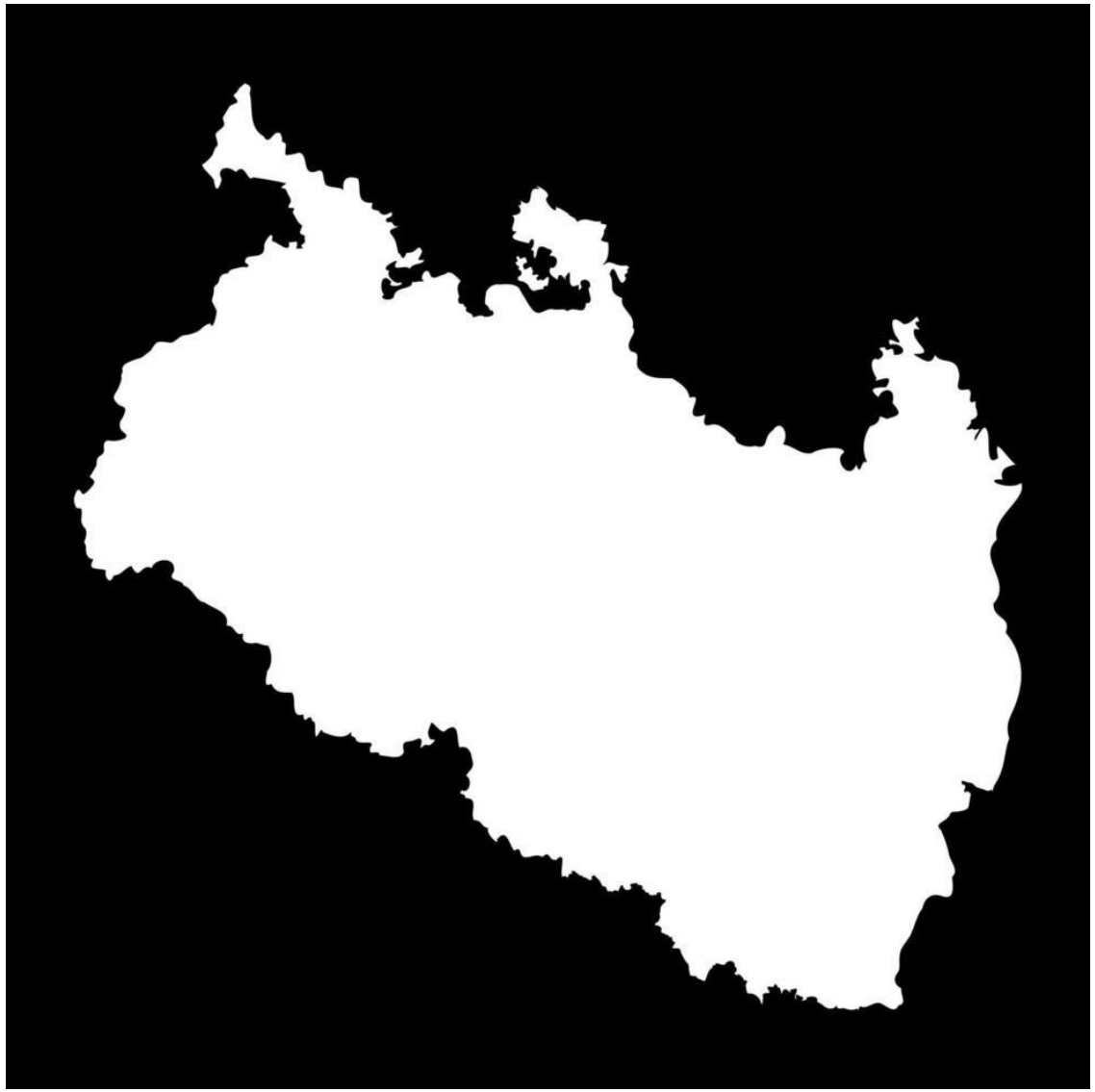
British Period

After the **East India Company** obtained *Diwani* rights in **1765**, Rangpur came under British rule. The **Fakir-Sannyasi Rebellion** occurred in the Rangpur region, with leaders like **Fakir Majnu Shah** playing a significant role. Notable anti-colonial rebels such as **Devi Chaudhurani** and **Bhabani Pathak** also originated from this region. During the **Sepoy Mutiny of 1857**, rebellious sepoys spread fear among the British rulers in Rangpur. Later, in **1930**, the **Civil Disobedience Movement** began in various parts of Rangpur following the call of the Indian National Congress. In **October 1946**, a meeting of peasant leaders from North Bengal was held in Rangpur, leading to the launch of the **Tebhaga Movement** in **November**.

History of Rangpur Division

Pakistani Period and Liberation War: During the Pakistani period, Rangpur was a district of **East Pakistan**. The people of Rangpur actively participated in major political movements, including the **Bengali Language Movement**, the **Six-Point Movement**, and the **1969 Mass Uprising**. The first martyr from Rangpur during the Liberation War was **Sangku Samajhder**, who was killed on **3 March 1971**. The people of Rangpur initiated armed resistance by attacking the **Rangpur Cantonment** on **28 March 1971**, only three days after the Pakistani military crackdown. During the **Bangladesh Liberation War**, Rangpur fell under **Sector 6** of the Bangladesh Forces and was strategically significant due to its proximity to the Indian border.

Post-Independence Period: In **1984**, the former Greater Rangpur district was divided into **five separate districts**. On **28 June 2012**, **Rangpur Municipality** was upgraded to **Rangpur City Corporation**, and on **16 September 2018**, Rangpur was declared the **eighth metropolitan city** of Bangladesh.



Educational Institutes in Rangpur

UNIVERSITIES

Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur

MEDICAL AND DENTAL COLLEGES

- Rangpur Medical College
- Prime Medical College
- Rangpur Community Medical College
- Northern Private Medical College
- Rangpur Army Medical College
- Kasir Uddin Memorial Medical College
- Rangpur Dental College





Begum Rokeya University

- **Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur** — **abbreviated as BRUR**, and formerly known as **Rangpur University** — is a **public research university** in **Rangpur, Bangladesh**.
- **Founded in 2008**, it is the **only general-category university** in **Rangpur Division** and the **second public university** in the region.
- It was **named after Begum Rokeya**, the renowned **feminist writer and social worker**.



Educational Institutes in Rangpur

SCHOOLS

- Rangpur Zilla School
- Police Lines School and College, Rangpur
- Cantonment Public School and College, Rangpur
- Rangpur Govt. Girls' High School
- Lions School and College Rangpur
- Collectorate School and College, Rangpur
- Rangpur High School
- Shishu Niketan High School Rangpur



Rangpur Zilla School

- The school was established in **1832** as **Rangpur Zamindar School**, by the local **Zaminders (landlords)**. **Nathial Smith**, the district collector working for the **British East India Company-led government**, also had a **central role**.
- The school was **inaugurated by Lord William Bentinck**, the **erstwhile Governor General of Bengal**. The **Maharaja of Cooch Bihar** donated funds for the **construction of the school building**. **Krishna Nath Ray** joined as the **first headmaster** of the school.
- The school was **taken under the management of the Government of India in 1857**. It was **affiliated with Calcutta University**. In **1862**, it was **renamed to Rangpur Zilla School**.

Educational Institutes in Rangpur

COLLEGES

- Carmichael College
- Rangpur Cadet College
- Police Lines School and College, Rangpur
- Cantonment Public School And College, Rangpur
- The Millennium Stars School & College
- BIAM Model School And College, Rangpur
- Rangpur Government College
- Begum Rokeya College
- Rangpur Engineering College
- Dr M A Wazed Miah Textile Engineering College
- Rangpur Marine Academy
- Collectorate School and College
- Carmichael Collegiate School and College
- Rangpur Technical School and College
- Rangpur Model College
- RCCI Public School & College
- Lions School & College
- Somaj Kolyan Women School & College
- Residential Model School and College
- Rangpur Public School and College
- Rangpur City College
- Siddique Memorial School & College
- Dhap Lalkuthi High School & College



Carmichael College

- **Carmichael College** is a symbol of **history and heritage in Rangpur**, founded in **1916**. It is one of the few institutions in **undivided Bengal** known for its **academic excellence** and **cultural impact**.
- The college has produced many distinguished individuals, including **Shaheed Janani Jahanara Imam**, **former Presidents Abu Sadat Md. Sayem and Hussain Md. Ershad**, and **Major General Mustafizur Rahman**, former Chief of Army Staff.
- Its reputation attracted students from **Assam**, **Cooch Behar**, **Jalpaiguri**, **Malda**, and especially from **greater Dinajpur and Rangpur**, thanks to its many **hostels** and renowned **teachers**.



Famous Tourist Places

Tajhat Palace (Tajhat Zamindar Bari)

The **Tajhat Zamindar House**, located near the **Rangpur Museum**, is a notable **historical landmark** tied to **Gopal Lal**, son of **Govinda Lal**, the founder of the **Tajhat dynasty**.

The building features a **north-south aligned hall** with **three access paths** to the **second floor**. The **ground floor** includes **four rooms**, **eleven pairs of doors**, **three large rooms** with **six entrances**, and a **large hall** with **double doors**.

A **22-step wooden staircase** in the **northern section** and an **iron suspension staircase** in the **southern palace** lead to the second floor, which features a **gallery-like staircase** finished in **smooth white and black stone**.

Today, the **Tajhat Zamindar House** stands as a **symbol of Rangpur's rich history and culture**.



Kantanagar Temple

The **Kantanagar Temple**, also known as **Kantaji Temple** or **Kantajew Temple**, is a **magnificent 18th-century Hindu temple** located in **Dinajpur, Bangladesh**. Dedicated to **Krishna** and **Rukmini**, it is an important site for the **Radha-Krishna cult** in Bengal.

Built by **Maharaja Pran Nath** in a **navaratna style**, the temple features **four-centered multi-cusped arches**, **plastered walls** with **rectangular and square paneling**, and a **prominent central archway and mihrab**.

The **terracotta murals**, influenced by folk artists from **Krishnanagar**, realistically depict deities and everyday society. Unlike other **Orissan** and **South Indian temples**, the Kantanagar Temple shows **restraint** in portraying erotic scenes.

Its **terracotta ornamentation** stands as a remarkable testament to the **rich cultural heritage** of Bangladesh.

Nilsagar

Nilsagar is a large **ancient pond** located at **Dharmapal village** in **Nilphamari district**, Bangladesh. Originally known as **Birnai Dighi**, it was excavated in the 8th century during the reign of **King Dharmapal** of the **Pala dynasty**.

The pond covers about **21.45 acres** of water area within a total area of **42.5 acres**, and is surrounded by a **brick wall**. It serves as an important **archaeological site**, **pilgrimage spot**, and a **popular tourist attraction**. In recent years, the site has been developed with various facilities for visitors.

Nilsagar reflects the **ancient heritage** and **historical significance** of the region.





Ramsagar Dighi

Ramsagar is a large **artificial lake** located near **Dinajpur town**, Bangladesh. It was excavated in the 18th century by **Raja Ram Nath**, after whom it is named.

The lake covers about **4.4 hectares** (approximately **110 acres**) and measures around **1,079 meters** in length and **192.6 meters** in breadth. It was created to provide water for local inhabitants and is now a **popular tourist destination**, known for its **natural beauty** and **historical value**.

Today, **Ramsagar** serves as an important site for **recreation**, **ecotourism**, and the **preservation of local biodiversity**.



Bhitargarh

Bhitargarh is an important **archaeological site** located about 16 kilometers northeast of **Panchagarh town** in Bangladesh. It is considered the **largest fortified ancient city** discovered in the country, dating back to around the **5th century AD**. The site was possibly established during the rule of **King Prithu** and functioned as an independent city-state until the **13th century**.

Bhitargarh is known for its impressive **fortification system**, consisting of **four concentric quadrangular walls** made of earth and brick, surrounded by **moats**. Key features of the site include a **cruciform temple**, a **pyramidal stupa**, **pillared halls**, and an advanced **water management system** with several ancient ponds, including the notable **Maharajar Dighi**.

The city served as a major **trade center**, connecting Bengal with **Tibet**, **Bhutan**, and **China** through ancient trade routes. However, the site currently faces threats from **encroachment** and **local agricultural activities**, highlighting the urgent need for **preservation efforts**. Bhitargarh remains a significant testament to the **early urbanization and cultural history** of Bangladesh.



Teesta Barrage

The **Teesta Barrage**, located at **Duani, Hatibandha Upazila** in **Lalmonirhat District**, is the largest irrigation project in Bangladesh. Built across the **Teesta River**, it spans **615 meters** and controls water flow through **44 radial gates**. Completed in **1997–98**, it supplies water to vast agricultural lands.

Besides its importance for irrigation, the barrage has become a popular **tourist attraction**. Visitors enjoy the river's shifting colors—**blue**, **green**, and **turquoise**—and **boat rides** through calm and rapid currents. A nearby **riverside park** and the **Oboshor Resthouse** offer scenic spots for relaxation and family outings.



Traditional foods of Rangpur

SHIDOL: FERMENTED FISH DELICACY

Shidol is a fermented fish dish, traditionally made by drying small fishes for several days, then grinding and mixing them with mashed arum, salt, pepper, and ginger. The mixture is shaped into mounds, coated with turmeric and mustard oil, and sun-dried again. Preservation involves storing the mounds in ash. Before consumption, Shidol is typically cooked with various fishes. The complex preparation process contributes to its rarity in modern times.



Traditional foods of Rangpur

SHOLKA: A TRADITIONAL SPINACH-BASED DISH

Sholka is a traditional dish from the Rangpur region, primarily made with various types of spinach, including jute leaves and taro stems. The preparation involves wrapping and finely chopping the greens, then mixing them with ingredients such as baking soda, salt, pepper, ginger, and garlic. Occasionally, jackfruit seeds are added to enhance the flavor. Despite its seemingly simple ingredients, the dish requires a unique chopping technique, making its preparation quite intricate.



PALKA SHALKA – VEGETABLE SOUP

This is one of the **most favourite dishes from Rangpur**, which is somewhat similar to a **vegetable soup**.

In **Rangpur**, this is made mainly with **nafa/lafa shaak (Chinese mallow)**, **bothua shaak (white goosefoot)**, and **barb/Babura shaak (chopsuey green)**.

Mashed potatoes and **beef bhuna** are often eaten together with **palka shalka**.

Renowned Personalities of Rangpur Division

Roquiah Sakhawat Hossain (1880-1932)

Roquiah Sakhawat, born in 1880, was a significant figure in the awakening of Muslim women. Despite her father's belief that women should not receive education beyond home, she learned both Bangla and English at home. She married Syed Sakhawat Hossain and started the Sakhawat Memorial Girls' School in 1909, offering various subjects for Muslim girls. Roquiah's writings, including Abarodhbasini and Matichur, encouraged women to protest injustices and break social barriers. In 1916, she founded Anjuman-e-Khawatin-e-Islam, a Muslim women's society.



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